FOREWORD

"Whether through economic pressure, political and military intimidation, espionage, or propaganda, Beijing is actively trying to reshape the world to fit its interests, picking and choosing which Western norms it adopts and which it ignores. . . . The 'new China rules' . . . are the . . . greatest strategic challenge of the next generation."

It would be hard to improve upon this summary by Michael Auslin of the way Washington now perceives China. The point is that Auslin has been making such arguments for many years. It is only in the last two that they have become part of a new consensus.

Recall the 2015 National Security Strategy document, the last published by the administration of Barack Obama. "The scope of our cooperation with China is unprecedented," it declared. "The United States welcomes the rise of a stable, peaceful, and prosperous China. We seek to develop a constructive relationship with China that delivers benefits for our two peoples and promotes security and prosperity in Asia and around the world. We seek cooperation on shared regional and global challenges. . . . While there will be competition, we reject the inevitability of confrontation."[1]

Compare and contrast this language with the December 2017 edition, published during H. R. McMaster's tenure as President Donald Trump's national security adviser: